

Seeded Questions

Unlocking Deeper Insight Through Better Questions

Most workshops don't lack expertise. They lack the right questions at the right moment.

What are Seeded Questions?

Seeded Questions are **pre-designed, high-quality questions** that are intentionally introduced into a workshop at key moments to deepen discussion, unlock insight, and drive engagement.

Rather than relying on spontaneous audience questions—which can often fall flat or not materialise at all—seeded questions ensure that **valuable lines of inquiry are always explored**.

Why It Works

1. Avoids the “Deer-in-Headlights” Moment

- When participants are presented with new information—particularly from senior leaders or SMEs—they often:
 - Need time to process
 - Struggle to formulate meaningful questions on the spot
 - Default to silence or surface-level engagement

Seeded questions bridge this gap by ensuring **depth isn't left to chance**.

2. Leverages the Facilitator's Advantage

- Understand the **intent of the session**
- Have visibility of **content ahead of time**
- Can anticipate **gaps, tensions, and areas of ambiguity**

This gives us a unique opportunity to:

- Design questions that **move understanding forward**, not just clarify basics.

3. Extends and Enriches SME Contributions

- Seeded questions allow presenters to:
 - Share **insights beyond their prepared material**
 - Expand on **nuance, trade-offs, and real-world complexity**
 - Surface perspectives that may not have been initially planned

In effect, you get **more value from limited access to senior expertise**.

4. Creates Processing Time for Participants

- While seeded questions are being asked and answered:
 - Other participants gain time to **digest the content**
 - Understanding becomes more **collective and aligned**

Confidence builds for participants to **engage with their own questions**



Example Seeded Questions

1. “What assumptions underpin this approach, and where might they break down?”
2. “If we had to scale this quickly, what would be the first constraint we'd hit?”
3. “What are we not seeing from this perspective?”
4. “How would this look different in 12 months' time?”

Outputs

- Deeper, shared understanding across participants
- More **meaningful engagement** with SMEs and leaders
- Increased **confidence and participation** in discussions
- Stronger foundation for **downstream workshop activities**

Final Reflection

If you're relying on participants to ask great questions in the moment, you're leaving one of the most valuable parts of your workshop to chance.

Design the questions, and you design the conversation.